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Auto Parts & Tires | Japan

Feedback from Meetings with Overseas Investors

Key Takeaways

- Investors generally remained on the sidelines with regards to the auto parts industry, given sluggish growth in vehicle production and intensifying competition with local Chinese parts suppliers.
- Stock-specific interest was concentrated on names with AI/DC growth opportunities, including GS Yuasa, NHK Spring, and Musashi Seimitsu Industry.
- There was also some interest in tire makers (Toyo Tire, Yokohama Rubber), TIER IV, and Denso.
- Investors recognized stock-specific growth stories at Toyoda Gosei (airbags) and Nifco (plastic products), but some noted that it was difficult to identify new catalysts.

We visited US institutional investors from October 5-8. Most questions during the meetings focused on three names: GS Yuasa (US investor interest in energy storage systems was also high, with many questions regarding GS Yuasa’s competitive advantages), NHK Spring (interest in HDD suspensions was strong, including the potential impact of increased nearline HDD production at a Toshiba subsidiary), and Musashi Seimitsu Industry (including views on the timing of the start-up of the new Minami-Alps plant). Elsewhere, although the recent further rise in natural rubber prices has raised concerns about F12/27 earnings for tire makers, interest appeared high in Toyo Tire (attractive valuations) and Yokohama Rubber (new medium-term management plan starting next fiscal year). Investors also asked about Denso (including its stance on acquisitions of semiconductor companies and views on the suspension of the spark plug business divestiture), as well as about TIER IV (e.g., its competitive advantages in autonomous driving software).

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AUTO PARTS	
Japan	
Industry View	In-Line
TIRES	
Japan	
Industry View	In-Line

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(as of September 30, 2026)

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	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1599	43%	455	48%	28%	783	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1563	42%	394	42%	25%	763	43%
Not-Rated/Hold	2	0%	1	0%	50%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	570	15%	96	10%	17%	227	13%
Total	3,734		946			1774	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (10/08/2026)
Hayato Takashima		
Nifco (7988.T)	O (03/06/2024)	¥2,473
Shinji Kakiuchi		
Aisin (7259.T)	E (06/09/2026)	¥2,196
Denso (6902.T)	E (06/09/2026)	¥1,826
EXEDY (7278.T)	E (09/04/2025)	¥5,730
F.C.C. (7296.T)	E (09/09/2026)	¥4,085
GS Yuasa Corporation (6674.T)	O (04/21/2026)	¥5,511
Koito Mfg. (7276.T)	E (10/08/2025)	¥2,732
Musashi Seimitsu Industry (7220.T)	E (02/09/2026)	¥3,020
NHK Spring (5991.T)	O (07/09/2024)	¥3,843
Stanley Electric (6923.T)	E (03/06/2025)	¥3,503
TIER IV (593A.T)	O (08/24/2026)	¥2,476
TOKAI RIKI (6995.T)	E (03/03/2026)	¥3,035
Toyoda Gosei (7282.T)	O (03/06/2024)	¥1,055
Toyota Boshoku (3116.T)	U (09/09/2026)	¥2,150
TS Tech (7313.T)	U (03/06/2025)	¥1,751
Unipres (5949.T)	U (09/09/2026)	¥1,264

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* Historical prices are not split adjusted.

INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Tires

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (10/08/2026)
Shinji Kakiuchi		
Bridgestone (5108.T)	E (03/16/2026)	¥3,882
Sumitomo Rubber (5110.T)	E (07/24/2025)	¥2,009

Toyo Tire (5105.T)	O (07/24/2025)	¥3,995
Yokohama Rubber (5101.T)	E (02/02/2026)	¥7,284

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* Historical prices are not split adjusted.